

Project Plan Report

IT Disaster Recovery and Business Continuity Planning for a Banking System

Unit Code: ITSU2006

Group Name: SYD 43

Assessment: Project Plan Document and Demonstration

Prepared by:

Table 0: Group member details and contribution summary

Student Name	Student ID	Contribution
Vansh Munjal	65616	Introduction, Scope Statement and Change Request Management
[Member 2 Name]	[Student ID]	Gantt Chart and Project Schedule
[Member 3 Name]	[Student ID]	Risk and Issues Management Strategy
[Member 4 Name]	[Student ID]	GitHub, Jira Evidence and Final Editing

Lecturer/Tutor: [Tutor Name]

Campus: Sydney

Submission Date: [Date]

Footer for every page: Vansh Munjal | 65616 | Page X of Y

1. Introduction

IT Disaster Recovery is the methodical planning, the set of procedures and resources, and the technical controls implemented to bring back the information systems to a normal state after experiencing a major disruption like a cyber attack, hardware failure, software corruption, power outage, natural disaster, human error or data centre failure. In an IT environment, disaster recovery is aimed at getting back the critical systems applications databases, networks and infrastructure up and running at a level of downtime that is considered acceptable. Business Continuity Planning is a wider concept that is very much related. It makes sure that a business can keep its main functions going throughout a disruption and even afterward, and this happens despite IT services being down for a while.

For a banking system, IT Disaster Recovery and Business Continuity Planning go hand in hand. Banking services rely on continuous availability accuracy confidentiality and integrity of digital systems. The housework of banks has nowadays come down to the online banking platform, mobile banking apps, ATM services, card payment networks, customer databases, transaction processing systems, internal employee systems and third-party service providers. If any of these fail, it would be a very serious matter for the bank. The bank might suffer losses, discontented customers, damage of reputation, legal matters and non-compliance of regulations. It is part of the operational resilience that the Australian financial sector has as a major expectation because regulated entities need to be able to continue critical operations through disruptions and also to manage operational risks effectively.

This report offers a project plan to build an IT Disaster Recovery and Business Continuity Plan for a banking system. The project scope objectives deliverables, inclusions exclusions constraints, assumptions and change request management process have been covered in the report. Besides the report, it also integrates the group project by giving a solid basis for the Gantt chart, risk and issue management strategy, GitHub version control evidence and Jira-based team collaboration use case. The aim of this project is not to create a live banking disaster recovery environment, but to produce a realistic, controlled and fully documented project plan that exhibits project management knowledge, technical understanding and professional planning practice.

2. Comprehensive Scope Statement

2.1 Project Scope Overview

The goal of this project is to develop a comprehensive project plan for IT Disaster Recovery and Business Continuity Planning for a banking system. The project will not only list critical banking services but also assess various disruption scenarios, set recovery priorities, draft disaster recovery and business continuity plans, and develop a formal procedure for managing project changes. Also, the plan will reflect on how configuration management and collaboration tools like GitHub and Jira are employed to facilitate version control, team coordination, and proof of group contribution

Figure 1: Project scope overview for the banking disaster recovery and business continuity planning project



2.2 Project Objectives

The primary goal of this project is to draft a detailed and workable project plan illustrating how a banking system can anticipate, react to and recover from significant IT disruptions. The project goals are given in Table 1.

Table 1: Project objectives for IT Disaster Recovery and Business Continuity Planning

Objective No.	Project Objective	Expected Outcome
OBJ-1	Identify the critical IT services used in a banking system.	A clear list of essential services such as online banking, ATM services, payment processing, customer database and internal banking applications.
OBJ-2	Define the disaster recovery and business continuity planning approach.	A structured plan showing how the bank can maintain or restore critical services during disruptions.
OBJ-3	Establish recovery priorities for key banking systems.	Recovery expectations based on business impact, service importance and customer impact.
OBJ-4	Prepare project planning artefacts.	Scope statement, Gantt chart, risk register, issue register, change request process and final report.
OBJ-5	Demonstrate team collaboration and version control.	Screenshots and evidence from GitHub and Jira showing contribution, tracking and document control.
OBJ-6	Support final oral presentation and viva voce assessment.	Each group member can explain their contribution and answer questions confidently.

2.3 Project Deliverables

Project deliverables refer to the concrete items or results that the project team will produce. These deliverables be the yardstick to evaluate the project's extent to which it meets its planned scope.

Table 2: Project deliverables

Deliverable No.	Deliverable	Description
D1	Project Scope Statement	Defines project objectives, inclusions, exclusions, assumptions, constraints and boundaries.
D2	Banking System Overview	Describes the banking services and IT systems considered in the project.
D3	Business Impact Summary	Identifies the effect of disruption on critical banking operations.
D4	Disaster Recovery Planning Section	Explains recovery priorities, backup requirements and restoration planning.
D5	Business Continuity Planning Section	Explains how essential banking services can continue during disruption.
D6	Gantt Chart	Shows project activities, duration and dependencies between tasks.
D7	Risk Register	Identifies possible project and banking system risks with mitigation strategies.
D8	Issue Register	Records actual project issues, priority, owner and status.
D9	Change Request Management Process	Defines how changes are submitted, assessed, approved, rejected and documented.
D10	GitHub Repository Evidence	Demonstrates version control, file history, commits and repository structure.
D11	Jira Collaboration Evidence	Demonstrates task allocation, progress tracking and team coordination.
D12	Final Report	Combines all project components into one structured project plan document.
D13	Presentation/Demonstration Material	Supports the Session 12 oral presentation and individual viva questions.

2.4 Inclusions

The following are the items covered by this project:

1. A study of banking system from IT disaster recovery and business continuity.
2. Recognizing critical banking operations e.g. online banking, mobile banking, ATM access, payment processing, and customer databases and staff systems.
3. Creation of a project plan that is well organized with proper sections and headings.
4. Producing a scope statement with a list of deliverables constraints assumptions and change control process.
5. Making a Gantt chart to illustrate the activity sequence and interdependencies.
6. Drafting risk and issue management documents.
7. Managing project files and report drafts using GitHub.
8. Employing Jira for task distribution, monitoring progress and enhancing team cooperation.
9. Adding screenshots that demonstrate GitHub and Jira usage.
10. IEEE-style in-text citations and reference list.
11. Oral presentation preparation and demonstration of individual contribution.

2.5 Exclusions

The following items are not part of this project:

1. Making a disaster recovery system operational in a live banking environment.
2. Handling of genuine customer banking data or use of confidential financial records.
3. Buying physical disaster recovery infrastructure or cloud recovery services.
4. Complete installation of backup servers, failover systems or production recovery sites.
5. Conducting a formal regulatory audit or certification.
6. Attempting to breach a real bank's network or systems through penetration testing.
7. Creating a banking software application from scratch.
8. First-hand connection with payment networks, ATM networks or core banking platforms.
9. Legal investigation of banking compliance documents.
10. Continuous post-project maintenance after assessment submission.

Consider note that these exclusions are due to the project being an academic exercise for a project plan and not a live enterprise implementation.

2.6 Project Constraints

The project constraints are limitations that may affect how the project is completed.

Table 3: Project constraints

Constraint No.	Constraint	Impact on Project
C1	Limited assessment timeframe	The team must complete planning, documentation and tool evidence before the submission deadline.
C2	Academic project environment	The project must be based on research, planning and simulation rather than live banking implementation.
C3	No access to real banking infrastructure	The team must use realistic assumptions instead of actual bank systems.
C4	Team availability	Different schedules may affect meetings, task completion and review time.
C5	Tool familiarity	Some team members may require time to understand GitHub and Jira.
C6	Limited technical deployment	The focus is on project planning rather than full technical implementation.
C7	Referencing requirements	The report must use IEEE-style citations consistently.
C8	Presentation requirement	Each member must understand the project clearly enough to answer viva questions.

2.7 Project Assumptions

The project is based on the following assumptions:

Table 4: Project assumptions

Assumption No.	Assumption	Reason
A1	The banking system includes online banking, mobile banking, ATM services, payment processing and customer databases.	These are common critical systems in modern banking environments.
A2	The bank requires high availability and fast recovery of critical services.	Banking disruptions can directly affect customers and financial transactions.
A3	No real customer data will be used.	This protects privacy and keeps the project within academic boundaries.
A4	GitHub will be used for storing project	This supports configuration management

	files and version history.	and evidence of contribution.
A5	Jira will be used for task allocation and progress tracking.	This supports team collaboration and project monitoring.
A6	The final report will be submitted as a single structured document.	This aligns with the assessment requirement.
A7	All group members will contribute to the report and presentation.	Individual contribution will be assessed during the viva voce activity.
A8	The project will use recognised disaster recovery, business continuity and project management principles.	This improves the academic quality and credibility of the report.

2.8 Scope Acceptance Criteria

The project scope will be considered successfully completed when the following acceptance criteria are met:

Table 5: Scope acceptance criteria

Criteria No.	Acceptance Criteria	Measurement
AC1	The report includes a clear introduction and project purpose.	Introduction explains disaster recovery, banking relevance and report coverage.
AC2	The scope statement is comprehensive.	Objectives, deliverables, inclusions, exclusions, constraints and assumptions are included.
AC3	The Gantt chart shows interdependencies.	Activities show logical dependencies and task sequence.
AC4	Risk and issue management strategies are included.	Risk and issue registers are presented with owners and responses.
AC5	The change request process is documented.	The process explains submission, review, approval and documentation.
AC6	GitHub evidence is attached.	Screenshots show repository, commits and uploaded documents.
AC7	Jira evidence is attached.	Screenshots show tasks, status columns and assigned responsibilities.
AC8	IEEE referencing is used throughout.	In-text citations and reference list follow IEEE style.
AC9	Each team member can explain their contribution.	Member can answer presentation and viva questions clearly.

3. Change Request Management Process

3.1 Purpose of Change Request Management

Aims of change request management include making sure that any change proposed to the project is officially documented, evaluated, approved, or declined before implementation. Since this project consists of a number of interrelated elements like scope, schedule, Gantt chart, risks, issues, GitHub evidence, Jira evidence, and final report formatting, uncontrolled changes might lead to confusion or a decline in the quality of the final delivery. A formal change request procedure enables the project team to keep a handle on project scope, timelines, roles, and document versions.

Mainly in disaster recovery and business continuity planning, change management becomes a matter very important as changes in recovery priorities, system assumptions, risk ratings, or deliverables can have an impact generally on the project. Suppose the team decides to incorporate a new critical banking system like fraud detection or loan processing; then, the scope, Gantt chart, risk register, business impact analysis, and report structure may need alterations. So, all major changes should be reviewed before they are approved.

3.2 Types of Changes Covered

The change request management process applies to the following types of changes:

1. Changes to project scope.
2. Changes to deliverables.
3. Changes to project schedule or deadlines.
4. Changes to assigned responsibilities.
5. Changes to risk or issue management strategy.
6. Changes to disaster recovery assumptions.
7. Changes to report structure or formatting.
8. Changes to GitHub repository structure.
9. Changes to Jira tasks or workflow.
10. Changes requested after tutor feedback or team review.

Minor spelling, grammar, and formatting corrections do not require a formal change request unless they affect the meaning, structure, or assessment requirements of the report.

3.3 Change Request Workflow

The change request workflow explains how a proposed change moves from identification to final closure.

Figure 2: Change request management workflow

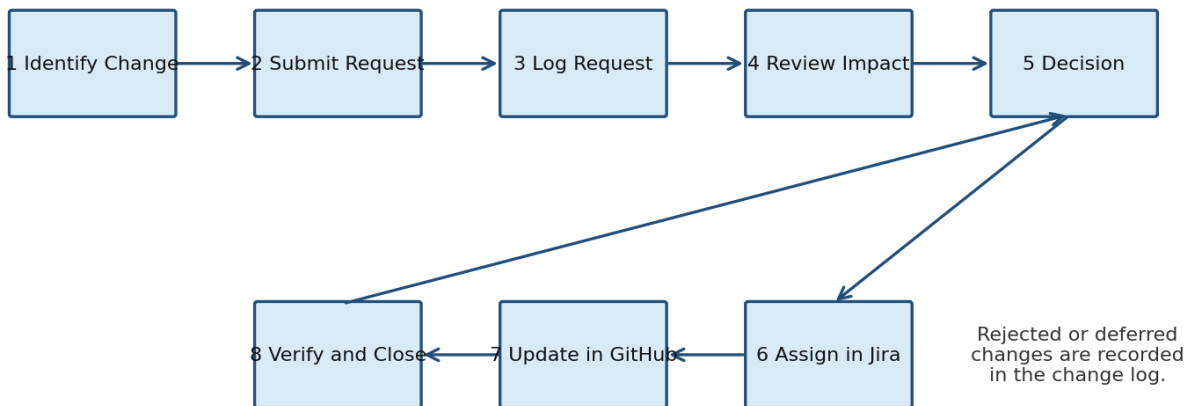


Table 6: Change request workflow stages

Step	Process Stage	Description	Responsible Person
1	Identify Change	A team member identifies a required change in scope, schedule, deliverable or document content.	Any team member
2	Submit Change Request	The team member completes a change request entry with reason, impact and urgency.	Requesting member
3	Log Change Request	The project manager records the change in the change request log.	Project manager
4	Initial Review	The project manager checks whether the change is minor, major or urgent.	Project manager
5	Impact Assessment	The team reviews the effect on scope, time, quality, marks, GitHub/Jira evidence and report consistency.	Project manager and relevant members
6	Decision	The change is approved, rejected or deferred.	Project manager and group members
7	Implementation	Approved changes are assigned in Jira and updated in the report.	Assigned team member
8	Version Control	Updated files are uploaded to GitHub with a clear commit message.	Assigned team member

9	Verification	The team checks whether the change has been correctly applied.	Reviewer
10	Closure	The change request is marked as closed in the change log.	Project manager

3.4 Change Approval Authority

Not all changes require the same level of approval. Minor changes can be approved quickly, but major changes must be discussed by the full team.

Table 7: Change approval authority matrix

Change Type	Example	Approval Required	Documentation Required
Minor Change	Correcting grammar, formatting, table numbering or citation style	Section owner	GitHub commit message
Moderate Change	Adding a new deliverable, changing a paragraph structure or updating a risk rating	Project manager and affected member	Change log and Jira task
Major Change	Changing project scope, Gantt chart timeline, key deliverables or banking system assumptions	Full group approval	Change request form, Jira update and GitHub commit
Urgent Change	Correction required before submission due to tutor feedback or missing rubric requirement	Project manager plus available members	Change log, GitHub commit and final review note

3.5 Change Request Form Template

Every significant change should be recorded using the template below.

Table 8: Change request form template

Field	Details
Change Request ID	CR-[Number]
Date Submitted	[Date]
Requested By	[Name]
Section Affected	[Scope / Gantt Chart / Risk Register / Issue Register / GitHub / Jira / References / Final Report]
Description of Change	[Explain the requested change clearly]
Reason for Change	[Explain why the change is required]
Impact on Scope	[Low / Medium / High]
Impact on Schedule	[Low / Medium / High]
Impact on Quality	[Low / Medium / High]

Priority	[Low / Medium / High / Urgent]
Decision	[Approved / Rejected / Deferred]
Approved By	[Name]
Jira Task Link/ID	[Task ID]
GitHub Commit Reference	[Commit message or file update reference]
Status	[Open / In Progress / Completed / Closed]

3.6 Change Request Log

The change request log records all changes made during the project. This provides evidence that the team managed project changes professionally.

Table 9: Change request log

CR ID	Requested Change	Reason	Impact	Decision	Status
CR-01	Add APRA operational resilience reference to introduction.	Improves banking-sector relevance and supports academic credibility.	Medium	Approved	Completed
CR-02	Add GitHub and Jira evidence requirements to scope deliverables.	Directly aligns with assessment instructions.	Medium	Approved	Completed
CR-03	Update scope exclusions to clarify that no real customer data is used.	Reduces privacy and ethical concerns.	Low	Approved	Completed
CR-04	Add change approval authority matrix.	Strengthens change management process.	Medium	Approved	Completed
CR-05	Revise report footer and table captions.	Ensures formatting compliance with assessment requirements.	Low	Approved	Completed

3.7 Documentation and Version Control of Changes

All the changes that have been approved will be recorded in the change request log and will be reflected in the relevant project artefacts. Jira will be the tool to allocate approved changes to the appropriate team member, monitor the progress of the task and verify the completion. GitHub will be the platform to keep updated report drafts, version history and be a proof of changes through commits. It is necessary that each commit be accompanied by a message that clearly describes the change, e.g. "Updated scope statement exclusions" or "Added change request management table."

This method of work is aligned with configuration management since the team is able to identify what was changed, by whom and when the change was made [4], [5]. In order not to compromise with the report quality, a major change should not be directly added to the final document without previous review. First, the modified part of the document should be verified for alignment with the project scope, Gantt chart, risk register, issue register and assessment rubric. After the change is validated, the project manager or the designated reviewer will give the final green light and close the change request.

3.8 Change Request Management Summary

The change request management process is a way of making sure that project changes are controlled justified reviewed, and documented thoroughly. It greatly minimizes confusion among the team members and also makes it easier to stick with the project goals, the assessment rubric, and the requirements of the final submission. Changing request log, Jira task tracking, and GitHub version control are ways the team can show their approach to project governance, collaboration, and configuration management as a professional one.

References

- [1] M. Swanson, P. Bowen, A. Phillips, D. Gallup, and D. Lynes, Contingency Planning Guide for Federal Information Systems, NIST Special Publication 800-34 Rev. 1, National Institute of Standards and Technology, 2010.
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- [3] Australian Prudential Regulation Authority, Prudential Standard CPS 230: Operational Risk Management, APRA, 2023.
- [4] GitHub Docs, "Repositories documentation," GitHub, 2026.
- [5] Atlassian, "Jira project management and team collaboration software," Atlassian, 2026.